

### Most Expensive Cellphone

The most expensive mobile phone is being crafted in Austria. Costing over £500,000 the phone has sections of pure gold and 2950 blue diamonds embedded on the cover. Peter Aloisson, the creator, makes around three phones a year with most retailing at £200,000.



### \$100 Laptop Closer To Reality

MIT Media Lab head, Nicholas Negroponte has unveiled the design for the \$100 laptop that will go into production early next year. The laptop is powered with a wind-up crank, has very low power consumption and will let children interact with each other while learning.



# Escape

HE DIDN'T EVEN DO IT!

## The MPAA Strikes Again

When will the RIAA (Recording Industry Association of America) and the MPAA (Motion Picture Association of America) stop suing innocent people? No, we mean *really* innocent people—those who haven't even downloaded illegal stuff at all?

There was a case some time ago of a grandmother being sued for downloading music, but there, well, you could have pinned it down to something like "ignorance of the law is not sufficient grounds for pardon." This time it's a grandfather who doesn't even "like watching movies." He's been sued because his grandson downloaded all of four movies on their home computer over the P2P service iMesh.

The MPAA filed a federal lawsuit for copyright

infringement in early November against 67-year-old Fred Lawrence, seeking \$600,000 (Rs 2.64 crore) in damages. This was after Lawrence refused an offer back in March to settle the matter by shelling out \$4,000 (Rs 1.76 lakh).

Lawrence said his grandson, who was then 12, downloaded the movies in December 2004, "out of curiosity," and that he had deleted them immediately. He also said the family already owned three of the four titles on DVD.

Now, we're guessing that's what his lawyers told him to say—why should the grandson have deleted them immediately after downloading them? And why would he have downloaded movies they already had on DVD?

In any case, the \$500,000 suit is, of course, in order to set an example. Kori

Bernards, VP of corporate communications for MPAA, claimed illegal downloading costs the movie industry an estimated \$5.4 billion a year.

It would be interesting to find out how they come up with such figures. Would someone who downloaded a movie necessarily have bought it if they hadn't been able to get it for free?

What about people who actually go to the theatre after seeing what they liked on their PC screens?

The \$5.4 billion figure probably assumes that movie pricing is correct and fair: what if it's not, and it turns out people think DVDs are priced too high?

The debate will rage for some time. Only two things are for sure: first, P2P is here to stay, and second, that suing a 67-year-old grandfather for something his 12-year-old grandson did is plain stupid.

## UNUSABLE!

### The Firefox Plug-in Finder Service

Firefox is a good browser. Still, there are instances when one would be better off using good old IE (or any other browser for that matter). So what do we have here? An awkward situation of having a single 'great browser' installed, and at the same time the necessity of resorting to another browser for certain sites.

OK, some sites aren't coded with Firefox in mind, but we also have the situation of missing plugins. For instance, check <http://snipurl.com/digitdec1>, a typical blog. Try it in IE and everything's fine. You cannot say the same for Firefox.

Moreover, Firefox talks about a missing plugin, offers to find a plugin, and then says it isn't able to find one. Worse still is the case with <http://snipurl.com/digitdec2>.

There's an embedded video on the page, and Firefox shows up *nothing*, not even the video Window! The plugin finder doesn't even pop up. To activate the plugin required (Windows Media Player), and to make the video window appear, you need to mess around with a .dll file.

Even after that, the plugin finder service doesn't detect WMP as the missing plugin! And we're talking about the latest version of Firefox—1.0.7! As you might expect, the same site works just fine in IE.



No embedded video in Firefox!

## Win! My Desktop

Think you have the most beautiful, most innovative desktop around? E-mail us with subject **'My Desktop'** and your postal address to [mydesktop@thinkdigit.com](mailto:mydesktop@thinkdigit.com), and *Digit* will publish the most eye-catching of them each month.

Next month's winner will receive a copy of **Local Area Networks Management Design And Security**

By Arne Mikalsen and Per Borgesen

Published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd



There is no winner for this month. The majority of entries we received used desktop theme packs. This is not allowed!